my Chef's book

Because it's that good

by Chef

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Beautiful Burger Buns

side · 40 min · 8 servings

INGREDIENTS

- 3 ½ cups all-purpose flour
- ¾ cup plus 2 tablespoons water, lukewarm
- 2 tablespoons butter, at room temperature
- 1 large egg
- ¼ cup granulated sugar
- 1 ¼ teaspoons table salt
- 1 tablespoon instant yeast
- 3 tablespoons butter, melted, divided
- 1 large egg white, whisked with 2 tablespoons cold water (optional)
- sesame seeds, or the seeds of your choice (optional)

STEPS

1. Weigh your flour; or measure it by gently spooning it into a cup, then sweeping off any excess.
2. Mix and knead all of the dough ingredients — by hand, mixer, or bread machine — to make a soft, smooth dough.
3. Cover the dough and let it rise until it's nearly doubled in bulk.
   (1h 30min)
4. Gently deflate the dough and divide it into eight pieces (about 100g each).
5. Shape each piece into a ball. Flatten each dough ball with the palm of your hand until it's about 3" in diameter.

6 Place the buns on a lightly greased or parchment-lined baking sheet. Cover and let rise until noticeably puffy.

(1h)

7 Toward the end of the rising time, preheat the oven to 375°F.

8 Brush the buns with about half of the melted butter. For seeded buns, brush the egg white/water mixture right over the melted butter and sprinkle buns with the seeds of your choice.

9 Bake the buns for 15 to 18 minutes, until golden.

(17 min)

10 Remove them from the oven and brush with the remaining melted butter. Cool the buns on a rack before slicing in half, horizontally.

Chimichurri Sauce Recipe

Argentinian · other · 5 min · 8 servings

INGREDIENTS

- ½ cup flat-leaf parsley, chopped
- 4 cloves garlic, minced
- 1 small shallot, finely minced (optional)
- 1 teaspoon dried oregano
- 1 small red chile, seeded and diced (or 2 tsp red pepper flakes)
- 3 tablespoons red wine vinegar
- 1 teaspoon salt
- ½ teaspoon fresh ground black pepper
- ¾ cup extra-virgin olive oil

STEPS

1. Use a knife to finely mince the parsley and garlic, along with the shallot if you're including it.
2. Combine the parsley, garlic, oregano, vinegar, red chile or red pepper flakes, salt, and black pepper in a medium-sized bowl.
3. Drizzle in the olive oil and mix thoroughly until all the ingredients are well combined and the mixture becomes thick, glossy, and spoonable.
4. Allow the chimichurri to rest for 15 minutes at room temperature to let the flavors blend together.

   (15 min)
5. Give it one more stir and use it as a sauce, dip, or marinade depending on your needs.

NOTES

Food processor option: Add parsley, garlic, shallot, oregano, vinegar, chile, salt, and pepper to a small food processor and pulse just until chopped (do not blend into a paste). Transfer to a bowl and stir in the olive oil by hand. Chimichurri should be chunky and spoonable, not smooth like pesto. Store in the refrigerator for up to 1 week. Best when fresh - tastes brightest the day it's made.

Chicken Liver Pâté

French · starter · 35 min · 8 servings

INGREDIENTS

- ½ pound chicken livers, well-trimmed
- ½ small onion, thinly sliced
- 1 small garlic clove, smashed and peeled
- 1 bay leaf
- ¼ teaspoon thyme leaves
- ½ teaspoon kosher salt, plus more to season
- ½ cup water
- 1 ½ sticks unsalted butter, at room temperature
- 2 teaspoons Cognac or Scotch whisky
- freshly ground black pepper
- toasted baguette slices, for serving

STEPS

1. Assemble all your ingredients before you begin.

2. Pour the chicken livers, onion, garlic, bay leaf, thyme, and 1/2 teaspoon of salt into a medium saucepan with the water. Bring everything to a gentle simmer, then put the lid on, turn the heat down to low, and let it cook gently while stirring from time to time until the livers are just barely pink in the center, which should take about 3 minutes.

   (3 min)

3. Take the pan off the heat and allow it to rest with the lid in place for 5 minutes.

   (5 min)

4. Remove and discard the bay leaf. Use a slotted spoon to scoop the livers, onion, and garlic into your food processor, then blend them until you have a rough purée.

5. Keep the processor running and introduce the butter in 2-tablespoon portions, letting each addition fully blend in before adding more.

6. Pour in the Cognac, taste and adjust the seasoning with salt and pepper, then continue processing until the mixture becomes silky and smooth.

7. Divide the pâté among two or three large ramekins, press a piece of plastic wrap directly against the top surface, and place in the refrigerator until it reaches a firm consistency.

8. Serve the pâté cold.

NOTES

Chicken liver pâté freezes well; just let it thaw in the refrigerator overnight or for several hours before serving. If you're making it the day you want to serve it, be sure to give it several hours in the refrigerator to firm up first. For Passover or dairy-free preparation, swap margarine for butter.

Cranberry-Orange Relish

side · 99 servings

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups cranberries
- ½ orange
- ¾ cup sugar
- ¼ teaspoon fresh grated ginger

STEPS

1. Finely chop the cranberries and orange (peel and pulp) in Cuisinart.
2. Stir in the sugar.
3. Cover and refrigerate at least 3 hours.
   (3h)
4. Keep the leftovers from Thanksgiving to Christmas.
5. I make 2 batches, one with ginger, one without.

NOTES

Recipe No. 138. Some handwritten notes appear on the recipe card but are partially unclear.

Croissants

French · bread · 8 servings

INGREDIENTS

- 4 0.67 cups all-purpose or bread flour, plus more for dusting
- 8 cup granulated sugar
- 1 ½ tablespoons kosher salt
- 2 ¼ teaspoons active dry yeast
- 0.88 cup water, at room temperature
- ½ cup whole milk, at room temperature
- ¼ cup unsalted butter, cut into ½-inch pieces, chilled
- 1 ½ cups unsalted European or European-style butter, chilled
- all-purpose flour, for rolling
- 1 large egg yolk
- 1 tablespoon heavy cream

STEPS

1. Twenty-four hours before serving, start the détrempe: In the bowl of a stand mixer fitted with the dough hook, combine the flour, sugar, salt and yeast, and stir to combine. Create a well in the center, and pour in the water and milk. Mix on low speed until a tight, smooth dough comes together around the hook, about 5 minutes. Remove the hook and cover the bowl with a damp towel. Set aside for 10 minutes.

   (15 min)

2. Reattach the dough hook and turn the mixer on medium-low speed. Add the butter pieces all at once and continue to mix, scraping down the bowl and hook once or twice, until the dough has formed a very smooth, stretchy ball that is not the least bit sticky, 8 to 10 minutes.

   (10 min)

3 Form the dough into a ball and place seam-side down on a lightly floured work surface. Using a sharp knife, cut two deep perpendicular slashes in the dough, forming a "+." (This will help the dough expand into a square shape as it rises, making it easier to roll out later.) Place the dough slashed-side up inside the same mixing bowl, cover with plastic wrap and let rise at room temperature until about 1½ times its original size, 45 minutes to 1 hour. Transfer the bowl to the refrigerator and chill for at least 4 hours and up to 12.

(5h)

4 As the dough chills, make the butter block: Place the sticks of butter side-by-side in the center of a large sheet of parchment paper, then loosely fold all four sides of the parchment over the butter to form a packet. Turn the packet over and use a rolling pin to lightly beat the cold butter into a flat scant ½-inch-thick layer, fusing the sticks and making it pliable. (Don't worry about the shape at this point.) The parchment may tear. Turn over the packet and unwrap, replacing the parchment with a new sheet if needed. Fold the parchment paper over the butter again, this time making neat, clean folds at right angles (like you're wrapping a present), forming an 8-inch square. Turn the packet over again and roll the pin across the packet, further flattening the butter into a thin layer that fills the entire packet while forcing out any air pockets. The goal is a level and straight-edged square of butter. Transfer the butter block to the refrigerator.

5 Eighteen hours before serving, remove the dough from the refrigerator, uncover and transfer to a clean work surface. (It will have doubled in size.) Deflate the dough with the heel of your hand. Using the four points that formed where you slashed the dough, stretch the dough outward and flatten into a rough square measuring no more than 8 inches on one side.

6 Place 2 pieces of plastic wrap on the work surface perpendicular to each other, and place the dough on top. Wrap the dough rectangle, maintaining the squared-off edges, then roll your pin over top as you did for the butter, forcing the dough to fill in the plastic and form an 8-inch square with straight sides and right angles. Freeze for 20 minutes.

(20 min)

7 Remove the butter from the refrigerator and the dough from the freezer. Set aside the butter. Unwrap the dough (save the plastic, as you'll use it again) and place on a lightly floured surface. Roll the dough, dusting with flour if necessary, until 16 inches long, maintaining a width of 8 inches (barely wider than the butter block). With a pastry brush, brush off any flour from the surface of the dough and make sure none sticks to the surface.

8 You're going to enclose the butter block in the dough and roll them out together. To ensure they do so evenly, they should have the same firmness, with the dough being slightly colder than the butter. The butter should be chill

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NOTES

Make sure your first attempt at croissants is a successful one, with these tips, and Claire Saffitz's step-by-step video on YouTube.

Focaccia

Italian · bread · 30 min · 4 servings

INGREDIENTS

- 1024 g flour, bread
- 512 g water
- 20 g salt
- 16 g yeast
- 910 g water, 90°F
- 455 g water
- olive oil
- flaky salt
- rosemary

STEPS

1. Mix flour and bread flour
2. Let rise for 12 hours to 3 days
   (72h)
3. Second rise for 3-4 hours
   (4h)
4. Bake at 425°F
5. Dimple and oil
6. Bake for 25-30 minutes
   (30 min)

NOTES

Some measurements are partially unclear due to handwriting. Recipe appears to be written on index card format.

Honey Glazed Carrots

American · side · 20 min · 4 servings

INGREDIENTS

- 1 lb baby carrots
- 3 tbsp unsalted butter
- 3 tbsp honey
- ½ cup chicken broth
- 1 tsp fresh thyme leaves
- ½ tsp salt
- ¼ tsp black pepper, freshly ground

STEPS

1. In a large skillet or saucepan, melt the butter over medium heat.
2. Add the baby carrots to the pan and cook, stirring occasionally, for 3-4 minutes until lightly browned.

   (4 min)
3. Pour in the chicken broth and bring to a gentle simmer.
4. Cover and cook for 8-10 minutes, or until carrots are tender when pierced with a fork.

   (10 min)
5. Remove the lid and stir in honey, thyme, salt, and pepper.
6. Continue cooking uncovered for 2-3 minutes, stirring frequently, until the liquid reduces to a glossy glaze that coats the carrots.

   (3 min)
7. Taste and adjust seasoning if needed. Serve immediately while hot.

NOTES

For best results, use fresh baby carrots rather than baby-cut carrots. If using regular carrots, cut them into 2-inch pieces on the diagonal. The glaze should be thick enough to coat the carrots but not sticky.

Mediterranean Herb-Crusted Leg of Lamb

Mediterranean · main · 2h 20min · 8 servings

INGREDIENTS

- 4 lb leg of lamb, bone-in, trimmed
- 6 cloves garlic, minced
- 3 tablespoons fresh rosemary, chopped
- 2 tablespoons fresh thyme, chopped
- ¼ cup olive oil
- 2 tablespoons lemon juice, fresh
- 2 teaspoons salt, coarse sea salt
- 1 teaspoon black pepper, freshly ground
- 1 teaspoon dried oregano
- fresh rosemary sprigs, for garnish

STEPS

1. Remove lamb from refrigerator and let come to room temperature.

   (1h)

2. Preheat oven to 450°F (230°C).

3. In a small bowl, combine minced garlic, chopped rosemary, thyme, olive oil, lemon juice, salt, pepper, and oregano to make a paste.

4. Score the lamb with shallow cuts and rub the herb paste all over the surface, pressing into the cuts.

5. Place lamb on a roasting rack in a heavy roasting pan. Roast at 450°F for 15 minutes.

   (15 min)

6. Reduce oven temperature to 325°F (160°C) and continue roasting until internal temperature reaches 130°F for medium-rare.

   (1h 15min)

7 Remove from oven and tent with foil. Let rest before carving.

(15 min)

8 Carve lamb into slices and arrange on a serving platter. Garnish with fresh rosemary sprigs and serve immediately.

NOTES

For medium doneness, cook to 140°F internal temperature. Use a meat thermometer for accuracy. The lamb can be marinated with the herb paste up to 24 hours in advance for deeper flavor.

Liege Waffle Recipe

Belgian · bread · 30 min · 10 servings

INGREDIENTS

- ¾ cup warm milk
- 2 teaspoons yeast
- 2 tablespoons sugar
- 2 large eggs
- 12 tablespoons butter, melted
- 3 ½ cups all purpose flour
- 1 teaspoon sea or kosher salt
- 2 teaspoons vanilla
- 8 oz Belgian Pearl Sugar
- sliced strawberries (optional)
- raspberries (optional)
- bananas, sliced (optional)
- Nutella (optional)
- whipped cream (optional)
- powdered sugar (optional)

STEPS

1. Sprinkle yeast and sugar over warm milk in bowl of a stand mixer. Let sit for about 5 minutes until the yeast begins to foam.

   (5 min)

2. Add 2 eggs, melted butter and whisk together with fork.

3. Add 3 cups flour, salt and vanilla to yeast and milk mixture. Mix on low with dough hook until mixture is smooth.

4. Add remaining 1/2 cup of flour and mix on low for 2 minutes.

   (2 min)

5. Place in a warm location, covered for 30 minutes.

   (30 min)

6. After dough has risen, fold 8 oz of Belgian Pearl Sugar into dough using a large spoon or by hand.

7. Divide dough into pieces about 3-4 oz each. You should have 9-10 balls of dough.

8. Preheat waffle iron for 10 minutes before cooking dough.

   (10 min)

9. Generously grease waffle iron using cooking spray.

10. Cook one piece of dough at a time, placing dough in middle of waffle iron, close and cook until outside is crispy and center is cooked through. Cooking time will vary depending on heat level and waffle iron used. Watch carefully, as sugar will burn if cooked at too high temperature.

11. Lay cooked waffles on a wire rack while cooking remaining dough. May be kept in warm oven (225 degrees) until ready to serve, or serve immediately with toppings.

NOTES

To clean waffle iron, use a spatula to remove any remaining bits of sugar while waffle iron is still warm. You may also use a damp cloth or paper towel at the end of a silicone spatula to clean. Pearl Sugar is found at kitchen stores such as Orson Gygi in SLC, William Sonoma and online at Amazon.

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